Sprint Review and Retrospective

Throughout the development of the SNHU Travel project, I had the opportunity to understand the different roles and responsibilities of an Agile team. The project focused on developing a functionality inside the SNHU travel booking website that would help users find vacation destinations based on their preferences and budget. During the development, I worked through the responsibilities of the Scrum Master, Product Owner, tester, and developer. Each role helped me understand how communication, teamwork, and flexibility contribute to the success of a software development project while applying an Agile mindset.

For the following part, I will reflect on the work completed as the Scrum Master. I will go over the challenges faced, and how the Agile approach helped the team adapt to changes.

Applying Roles

One of the most important lessons I learned was how each role contributes to the development process. The Product Owner is responsible for understanding customer needs and communicating them to the team. During the User Stories assignment, I learned how interviews and meetings can help identify important features, such as the Hot Deals List, Vacation Preferences, and Price Limit features. These requirements were then organized into user stories to help guide development.

The developer is responsible for turning these requirements into working software, while the tester verifies that the features meet the expected results. During the testing assignment, I created test cases based on the user stories and realized that some requirements needed additional clarification. The Scrum Master helps these roles work together by encouraging communication, organizing Scrum events, and helping remove obstacles. I learned that even though each role has different

responsibilities, they depend on one another to deliver a product that meets the customer's expectations.

Completing User Stories

The Agile approach helped organize the development process by breaking larger requirements into smaller user stories. Instead of developing the entire functionality requested by users, the team could focus on individual features. For example, the Hot Deals List user story involved displaying vacation packages with descriptions, prices, and discounts. Another user story allowed customers to save their vacation preferences so the website could provide more relevant destinations in that same list.

I also learned that completing a user story involves more than writing code. The team must understand the requirements, develop the feature, and verify that it meets the expected results before considering it complete.

Handling Interruptions and Changes

One of the biggest challenges during the project was a change requested by the Product Owner. After meeting with the client, the Product Owner requested that the Top 5 destinations list focus only on detox and wellness travel destinations. This change affected both development and testing because the developer needed to update the list while the tester needed to prepare new test cases and do so without an extension on the deadline.

This experience demonstrated one of the main advantages of Agile. Instead of following a fixed plan regardless of new information, the team can adapt to customer needs.

Communication

Communication was an important part of the project because each role needed information from other team members. During the testing assignment, I prepared an email to the Product Owner asking for clarification about the Hot Deals List. One of my questions was:

"Should the user's preferences have priority over the amount of savings, or should the deals always be ordered by the largest price reduction?"

This question was important because it helped identify missing requirements that could affect the test results. I believe this communication example was effective because is asking a specific question instead of making assumptions. It also encouraged collaboration between the Product Owner, developer, and tester. As Scrum Master, I would encourage this communication through regular Scrum events so problems could be identified before they become larger issues.

Organizational Tools

During the communication journal, I discussed how information radiators, such as online task boards, can help teams understand project progress. One tool I recommended was Jira, which allows teams to organize tasks into stages such as To Do, In Progress, and Done (Atlassian, 2026). For the SNHU Travel project, Jira could help track user stories, development tasks, and testing activities.

Scrum events also support the effectiveness of these tools. Sprint Planning helps the team establish a shared goal, while the Daily Scrum allows developers to inspect progress and identify obstacles.

These practices support transparency, inspection, and adaptation, which are important principles of Scrum (Schwaber & Sutherland, 2020).

Evaluating the Agile Process

After reflecting on the SNHU Travel project, I believe Scrum-Agile was an appropriate approach for its development. One of its biggest advantages was flexibility. The change to the Top 5 destinations list showed how customer requirements can change during development. Agile allows teams to adjust their work and continue focusing on what provides the most value to the customer. Another advantage was collaboration. The Product Owner, developer, and tester needed to communicate regularly to make sure requirements were understood. Agile also supports continuous feedback, allowing teams to identify problems and make improvements throughout development (Cobb, 2015).

However, Agile also has disadvantages. Frequent changes can interrupt development and create additional work, especially when deadlines remain the same. It also requires consistent communication, and unclear requirements can lead to mistakes or repeated work. Scrum events can become time-consuming if they are not organized effectively.

Despite these challenges, I believe Agile was a better choice than a traditional Waterfall approach for this project. Since SNHU Travel involved changing requirements and features that could be developed separately, Agile provided more opportunities to review progress and make adjustments based on customer feedback.

References

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